MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

FUNCTIONAL SKILLS ENGLISH

CORE REVISION GUIDE • MODEL ANSWERS

LEVEL 2



WRITING SKILLS

A step-by-step guide to a high Level 2 writing score

All 11 Formats | Model Answers | Rhetoric & SPaG | Exemplar Mark Schemes

OFQUAL REGULATED SPECIFICATION • LEVEL 2

OFFICIAL STUDY MANUAL

ENGLISH WRITING LEVEL 2

Functional Skills English • Writing

Level 2 • Comprehensive Curriculum & Format Mastery Manual

This book belongs to:	Exam date:	Target level:
_____	_____	_____

What is inside

1–11	All 11 Authentic Writing Formats & Band 4 Models (55 pages)	p. 5
S1–S8	SPaG Masterclass & Complex Syntax Architecture (16 pages)	p. 60
M1–M2	2 Complete Official Pearson Mock Exam Papers (12 pages)	p. 76
RUB	Official Pearson Edexcel Band 1–4 Assessment Rubrics (4 pages)	p. 88
REF	Reference Solutions, Comprehensive Glossary & Index (11 pages)	p. 92
REV	Pre-Exam Readiness Commitments & Candidate Self-Audit	p. 103

How to use this book

Read
Read the rule. Study the picture.

Try
Write your answers on the lines.

Check
Mark it with the answers at the back.

Remember
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

CURRICULUM ARCHITECTURE • PEARSON SPECIFICATION QAN 603/4290/0

SPEC

Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Writing • Specification Overview

Pearson Edexcel Level 2 Assessment Structure

Examination Structure: The Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English Level 2 Writing examination is an externally assessed, **60-minute** paper comprising two distinct writing tasks:

- **Task 1 (Extended Writing • 21 Marks • 35 Minutes):** A high-challenge workplace, community, or professional scenario requiring an extended response of **250–350 words**. Assessed across Composition & Effect (12 marks) and SPaG (9 marks).
- **Task 2 (Structured Writing • 15 Marks • 25 Minutes):** A targeted functional response of **200–250 words** to a specific brief. Assessed across Composition & Effect (9 marks) and SPaG (6 marks).

Total Marks: 36 Marks • SPaG Weighting: 41.7% (15 marks total). Candidates must demonstrate sophisticated register, complete paragraph organisation, and accurate complex punctuation.

Golden Examiner Rule

Cover every single bullet point in the question prompt. Missing a bullet point caps your Composition score at Band 2.

Critical Audit Trap

Never use colloquial slang, unexpanded contractions (don't, can't), or informal text-speak in formal letters, reports, or articles.

✎ Personal Target Score & Revision Priorities

AUDIT

DIAGNOSTIC ASSESSMENT • BASELINE SKILLS AUDIT

Candidate Diagnostic Self-Audit Matrix

Core Functional Skills Level 2 Competencies

Assess your current confidence across the core Level 2 writing competencies before beginning the units:

- **All 11 Formats:** Can you immediately produce the layout markers for letters, emails, articles, reports, incident reports, leaflets, reviews, online forms, forums, newsletters, and reflective logs?
- **Paragraph Architecture:** Do you write cohesive paragraphs with clear topic sentences, evidence, and transitional discourse markers (Furthermore, Consequently, In contrast)?
- **Complex Sentence Variety:** Can you fluently embed subordinate clauses using conjunctions like 'although', 'whereas', 'unless', and 'provided that'?
- **Punctuation Precision:** Can you eliminate comma splices and accurately deploy semicolons, colons, apostrophes of possession, and bulleted lists?
- **Register Calibration:** Can you adapt your tone seamlessly from a formal incident report to an engaging community newsletter?

✎ Areas for Targeted Improvement During This Course

1

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Format 1: Article



Professional context for Article.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Readers of a community magazine or local town website. Tone / Formality: Semi-formal, engaging, balanced, and constructive. Specialist words: flexible working, work-life balance, productivity, commute, local businesses, wellbeing, facilities

Expected Tone & Register: Semi-formal, engaging, balanced, and constructive. Specialist words: flexible working, work-life balance, productivity, commute, local businesses, wellbeing, facilities

Essential Format Features: Catchy title, byline (By [Name]), introductory hook, subheadings for each section, clear paragraphs, strong concluding thought.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: flexible working, work-life balance, productivity, commute, local businesses, wellbeing.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

TASK

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 21 MARKS

Article • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 1

Context & Stimulus Material:
You see this notice on the community website Greendale Voice:
Call for Articles: Is Flexible Working Good for Our Community?
We want articles from local residents discussing the impact of remote and hybrid working.
• What are the benefits and drawbacks for employees and local businesses?
• How has flexible working affected work-life balance and local transport?
• What support or facilities are needed in our town?

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- evaluate the advantages and disadvantages of flexible working
- discuss its effect on personal wellbeing, local shops, and public transport
- suggest practical ways the local council and employers can support remote workers.

Word Count Target: 250 and 350 words **Marks:** 21 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Article • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Article

Flexible Working: Is It Helping or Hurting Our Community? By Alex Morgan Over the last few years, the way we work has changed completely. Many people in Greendale now work from home or do hybrid hours instead of travelling to an office every day. But is this new routine good for our town? The Benefits for Workers Firstly, flexible working has improved people's work-life balance . Without a stressful daily commute , workers spend more time with family, exercise, and cook healthy meals. Many residents report that their mental wellbeing is much better. In addition, people say their productivity has increased because they have fewer noisy distractions at home. Challenges for Local Shops and Transport On the other hand, there are clear drawbacks. Some workers feel lonely at home without colleagues. Furthermore, local town centre shops and cafes are losing money because fewer commuters buy lunch or coffee. Buses and trains are also less full, which could lead to reduced services in the future. What Support Is Needed? To make this system work for everyone, our council and employers must take action. The council should open shared workspace facilities in the library with fast internet and meeting rooms. Local cafes could offer discount cards for remote workers. Finally, employers must provide safe ergonomic equipment and check on staff regularly. In conclusion, flexible working is here to stay. If we work together to support workers and local businesses , our whole community will benefit.

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **flexible working:** working from home or choosing your work-life balance
- **and happy productivity:** the rate and quality of useful work you facilities

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Article • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario & Context: The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on Future Employment & Careers Audience & Tone: General readership of a national career and business magazine (*Modern Careers Magazine*). Specialist words: automation, generative AI, workforce, adaptability, ethical, productivity, reskilling • General readership of a national career and business magazine (*Modern Careers Magazine*). Specialist words: automation, generative AI, workforce, adaptability, ethical, productivity, reskilling

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
Modern Careers Magazine — Call for Feature Articles
"Feature Call: 'Will AI Take Your Job or Make It Better?' We invite thought-provoking articles examining the dual
realities of workplace automation. While AI tools accelerate productivity and remove routine admin, employees
legitimately fear job displacement and the loss of human interaction. How should workers and businesses
prepare?"

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- examine why artificial intelligence has become the defining talking point in modern employment
- analyze the tangible benefits of AI technologies for workers and enterprise productivity
- discuss the legitimate ethical concerns, risks of bias, and potential job displacement
- conclude with strategic recommendations on how professionals and adult learners can future-proof their

Strategy: Adopt an analytical, balanced tone. Use sophisticated discourse markers (Consequently, On the other hand, Paradoxically) to link your arguments.

Target: 250 and 350 words • **Key Words:** automation, generative AI, workforce, adaptability

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Article • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Article response below (250 and 350 words):**

2

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 200 AND 250 WORDS

Format 2: Email (Workplace)



Professional context for Email (Workplace).

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Workplace manager (Karen Davies). Tone / Formality: Formal, professional, clear, and persuasive. Specialist words: team-building, feedback, inclusive, budget, public transport, collaboration, proposal

Expected Tone & Register: Formal, professional, clear, and persuasive. Specialist words: team-building, feedback, inclusive, budget, public transport, collaboration, proposal

Essential Format Features: Clear Subject line, formal greeting (Dear [Name]), clear opening reason, bullet points for key details, polite sign-off (Kind regards), sender name and job title.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: team-building, feedback, inclusive, budget, public transport, collaboration.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

TASK

Email (Workplace) • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 2

Context & Stimulus Material:
You work as an administrative assistant at Apex Training Solutions. Your manager, Karen Davies, has asked
you to investigate options for an upcoming team-building day.
Feedback from colleagues:
• “Outdoor obstacle courses are too physically demanding for some team members.”
• “A cooking workshop or problem-solving escape room would suit everyone.”
• “We must keep the budget under £40 per person and choose a venue accessible by public transport.”

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- summarise the feedback gathered from your colleagues
- propose one specific venue/activity that meets all requirements
- explain why your chosen option offers good value and supports team cohesion.

Word Count Target: 200 and 250 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Email (Workplace) • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Email (Workplace)

To: karen.davies@apextraining.co.uk From: sam.taylor@apextraining.co.uk Subject: Proposal for Annual Staff Team-Building Day

Dear Karen, I am writing to share the feedback collected from our team regarding our upcoming team-building day and to propose a suitable plan. Overall, staff members are very enthusiastic about the event. However, colleagues pointed out that physically demanding activities, such as outdoor assault courses, are not suitable for everyone. The general view was that we need an inclusive indoor activity that encourages problem-solving. In addition, the venue must be close to public transport and stay within our £40 per person budget . Based on these requirements, I recommend booking the "Enigma Escape Rooms" in the city centre. This activity costs £28 per person, which leaves £12 per person for a buffet lunch. It is located just a five-minute walk from Central Train Station. This event is ideal because it requires clear communication and active collaboration in small groups. It allows every team member to participate fully regardless of physical fitness. I am confident this activity will boost team morale. Please let me know if you approve so I can confirm dates. Kind regards, Sam Taylor Administrative Assistant

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **proposal:** a formal plan or suggestion put forward for team-building

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

TASK

Email (Workplace) • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: Proposal for a Corporate Cycle-to-Work Scheme & Facilities Audience & Tone: Company Operations Director, Mr Marcus Vance (Formal, persuasive, and commercial). Specialist words: sustainability, carbon footprint, corporate social responsibility, secure storage, wellbeing, commute, infrastructure • Company Operations Director, Mr Marcus Vance (Formal, persuasive, and commercial). Specialist words: sustainability, carbon footprint, corporate social responsibility, secure storage, wellbeing, commute, infrastructure

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
Executive Staff Consultation Notice
"The executive board is reviewing our corporate sustainability charter and employee wellness incentives for the
upcoming financial year. We invite structured staff proposals that advance our net-zero targets while providing
measurable workplace benefits." — Marcus Vance, Operations Director

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- outline the purpose of your email and propose introducing an official Cycle-to-Work salary sacrifice scheme

Strategy: Maintain a persuasive, business-like tone. Structure your proposal logically with clear benefits and logistical requirements.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** sustainability, carbon footprint, corporate social responsibility, secure storage

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Email (Workplace) • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Email (Workplace) response below (150 and 250 words):**

3

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 300 WORDS

Format 3: Formal Letter



Professional context for Formal Letter.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: The General Manager of a hotel (Mr Marcus Vance). Tone / Formality: Formal, serious, polite, and firm. Specialist words: compensation, inconvenience, substandard, pre-booked, resolution, unacceptable, dissatisfaction

Expected Tone & Register: Formal, serious, polite, and firm. Specialist words: compensation, inconvenience, substandard, pre-booked, resolution, unacceptable, dissatisfaction

Essential Format Features: Sender address (top right), recipient address & date (top left), formal greeting (Dear Mr Vance), subject heading (Re: ...), factual description of issues, clear demand for compensation, formal sign-off (Yours sincerely).

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: compensation, inconvenience, substandard, pre-booked, resolution, unacceptable.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 21 MARKS

TASK

Formal Letter • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 3

Context & Stimulus Material:
You recently booked a weekend break at Highland View Hotel to celebrate a family milestone. During your
stay:
• The family room was not ready until 5:30 pm (two hours after the stated check-in time).
• The bedroom heating was broken, and reception failed to provide extra blankets.
• The restaurant was understaffed, resulting in a 75-minute wait for your pre-booked meal.
The duty manager on departure was dismissive and refused to offer an apology.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- explain why you are writing, providing dates and booking details
- explain the impact on your family celebration
- state clearly what compensation or remedial action you expect.

Word Count Target: 250 and 300 words **Marks:** 21 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Formal Letter • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Formal Letter

12 Meadow Close, Glasgow, G12 8QQ 3rd September 2026 Mr Marcus Vance, General Manager Highland View Hotel, 14 Glen Road, Fort William, PH33 6TQ Dear Mr Vance, Re: Formal Complaint Regarding Stay (Booking Ref: #HV-4092) I am writing to express my strong dissatisfaction with the service my family received at your hotel from 28th to 30th August 2026. We booked this stay to celebrate my mother's 70th birthday, but the experience was ruined by substandard service. Firstly, upon our arrival at 3:30 pm, our family room was not ready. We were forced to wait in the lobby until 5:30 pm without any apology. When we entered the room, the heating was broken and the room was freezing. Despite speaking to reception twice, no staff arrived to help or provide blankets. Secondly, our evening meal was unacceptable . We had a pre-booked table for 7:00 pm, yet we waited over 75 minutes for our food because the restaurant was understaffed. This delay caused great distress to my elderly mother. When I reported these issues upon checkout, the duty manager was dismissive. This poor service caused serious inconvenience and ruined a special family celebration. Therefore, I request a 50% refund of our booking (£240) as fair compensation and a written apology. I look forward to your response within 14 days to achieve a satisfactory resolution . Yours sincerely, Jordan Bell

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **dissatisfaction:** feeling unhappy or disappointed with a substandard

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Formal Letter • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario & Context: Planning Objection to Commercial Distribution Hub on Greenbelt Audience & Tone: Chief Planning Officer, Ms Diana Sterling, District Council (Formal, authoritative, and analytical). Specialist words: greenbelt, biodiversity, commercial development, infrastructure, environmental impact, congestion, objection • Chief Planning Officer, Ms Diana Sterling, District Council (Formal, authoritative, and analytical). Specialist words: greenbelt, biodiversity, commercial development, infrastructure, environmental impact, congestion, objection

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
District Council Public Planning Notice
Planning Application Ref: PLN/2026/0842 — Proposal to construct a 40,000 m² 24-Hour Logistics Distribution
Centre on the Meadowlands Greenbelt corridor. Formal representations and objections must be submitted in
writing to: Ms Diana Sterling, Chief Planning Officer, Borough Council Offices, High Street, Staveley, SV1 3PQ.

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- analyze the severe environmental damage to protected greenbelt, mature woodlands, and local biodiversity

Strategy: Follow full formal letter conventions. Use precise planning and environmental terminology to make your objections authoritative.

Target: 250 and 350 words • **Key Words:** greenbelt, biodiversity, commercial development, infrastructure

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Formal Letter • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Formal Letter response below (250 and 350 words):

4

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 320 WORDS

Format 4: Report



Professional context for Report.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Facilities Director (Ms Sunita Patel). Tone / Formality: Formal, objective, factual, and informative. Specialist words: survey, nutritious, subsidised, availability, recommendations, intake, proportion

Expected Tone & Register: Formal, objective, factual, and informative. Specialist words: survey, nutritious, subsidised, availability, recommendations, intake, proportion

Essential Format Features: Clear Title, formal header (To, From, Date, Purpose), subheadings for each section, factual survey data, numbered actionable recommendations.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: survey, nutritious, subsidised, availability, recommendations, intake.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

TASK

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 21 MARKS

Report • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 4

Context & Stimulus Material:
You are a member of the Health and Wellbeing Committee at your college or workplace. Management has
noticed low uptake of healthy food in the canteen and high consumption of junk food.
Survey findings (200 respondents):
• 68% find healthy meals in the canteen too expensive.
• 54% state the canteen runs out of vegetarian and salad options by 1:00 pm.
• 72% would buy fresh smoothies and fruit pots if prices were subsidised.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

Word Count Target: 250 and 320 words **Marks:** 21 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Report • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Report

Report on Healthy Food Choices in the Canteen To: Ms Sunita Patel, Facilities Director | From: Health and Wellbeing Committee Date: 3rd September 2026 | Purpose: To examine canteen food habits and recommend improvements.

Introduction Recently, canteen staff reported that sales of fresh meals have dropped while purchases of sugary snacks have increased. Our committee conducted a survey of 200 staff and students to investigate this problem. Survey Findings and Barriers The feedback highlighted three main barriers preventing people from choosing nutritious meals: Cost: A large proportion of respondents (68%) stated that healthy options are too expensive. A fresh salad costs £5.50, whereas chips and pasties cost only £2.50. Poor Availability : Over half of respondents (54%) noted that vegetarian and salad meals sell out by 1:00 pm, leaving late diners with only fast food. Snack Options: 72% confirmed they would buy fruit pots and smoothies if prices were lower. Recommendations To improve the daily nutrient intake of staff and students, the following actions are recommended: 1. Introduce a subsidised "Healthy Meal Deal" (salad wrap, fruit, and water for £3.50). 2. Increase the daily preparation of vegetarian meals so stocks last until 2:30 pm. 3. Place water coolers and fruit baskets near the payment tills instead of sweets.

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **survey:** an investigation of the opinions or behaviour of a proportion

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Report • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario & Context: Review of Student Mental Health & Pastoral Provision Audience & Tone: College Board of Governors & Principal, Dr Alistair Finch (Formal, data-informed, and strategic). Specialist words: wellbeing, pastoral support, stigma, survey, counseling, wait times, early intervention, recommendations • College Board of Governors & Principal, Dr Alistair Finch (Formal, data-informed, and strategic). Specialist words: wellbeing, pastoral support, stigma, survey, counseling, wait times, early intervention, recommendations

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
College Principal & Governing Board Directive
"Following our annual student wellbeing survey, which revealed a 35% increase in self-reported anxiety and
unacceptable counseling waitlists, the governing board requires an authoritative report investigating current
pastoral shortcomings and recommending strategic interventions." — Dr Alistair Finch, Principal

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- examine the key survey findings concerning academic pressure, exam anxiety, and prolonged therapeutic

Strategy: Use professional report formatting: 1.0 Terms of Reference, 2.0 Key Findings, 3.0 Current Limitations, 4.0 Recommendations.

Target: 250 and 350 words • **Key Words:** wellbeing, pastoral support, stigma, survey

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Report • Candidate Response

✎ **Write your Report response below (250 and 350 words):**

5

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 200 AND 260 WORDS

Format 5: Incident Report



Professional context for Incident Report.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Operations Director and Health & Safety Committee. Tone / Formality: Formal, factual, objective, and precise. Specialist words: incident, operative, hazard, first aid, administered, root cause, preventative measures
Expected Tone & Register: Formal, factual, objective, and precise. Specialist words: incident, operative, hazard, first aid, administered, root cause, preventative measures
Essential Format Features: Clear administrative header (Date, Time, Location, Injured Person, Reporter), chronological event breakdown, immediate first aid actions, root cause analysis, preventative safety measures.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: incident, operative, hazard, first aid, administered, root cause.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

TASK

Incident Report • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 5

Context & Stimulus Material:
You are a warehouse shift supervisor at LogiPack Distribution Centre. Yesterday afternoon at 14:15, a minor
accident occurred in Aisle 4.
• Worker involved: Jason Miller (Warehouse Operative).
• Details: Jason slipped on liquid detergent leaking from a dropped carton.
• Injury: Bruised right wrist and sprained ankle. First aid administered by Sarah Khan; sent to Minor
Injuries Unit.
• Hazard notes: Yellow caution sign was locked in the storage cupboard instead of being deployed.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- describe precisely what happened in clear chronological sequence

Word Count Target: 200 and 260 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Incident Report • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Incident Report

LogiPack Distribution: Workplace Incident Report Date of Incident: 2nd September 2026 | Time: 14:15 Location: Main Warehouse, Aisle 4 (Cleaning Products) Injured Person: Jason Miller (Warehouse Operative) | Reported by: Liam Carter (Supervisor)

Description of the Incident At 14:15, Jason Miller was carrying two cardboard boxes along Aisle 4. He stepped onto a patch of spilled liquid laundry detergent that had leaked from a cracked container. He slipped and fell onto his right side, injuring his wrist and ankle. Immediate Action Taken I attended the scene immediately and called Sarah Khan, our workplace first-aider. First aid was administered promptly: an ice pack was placed on Jason's ankle and his wrist was bandaged. He was taken to the Minor Injuries Unit for an X-ray. I arranged for the spillage to be cleaned and dried immediately. Root Cause Analysis A box had been dropped by another worker 20 minutes earlier, creating a serious slip hazard . However, the worker failed to report it or set out the warning sign, which was locked in a cupboard. Preventative Measures 1. Place spill kits and warning signs at the entrance of every warehouse aisle. 2. Hold a refresher briefing reminding all staff to report and isolate spills immediately.

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **incident:** an unexpected event, usually an accident or operative
- **hazard:** a danger or safety risk that could cause harm root cause

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Incident Report • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: IT Phishing Security Breach & Network Quarantine Incident Audience & Tone: Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) & Data Governance Board (Technical, exact, and forensic). Specialist words: cybersecurity, phishing, malware, credentials, breach, quarantine, firewall, protocol • Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) & Data Governance Board (Technical, exact, and forensic). Specialist words: cybersecurity, phishing, malware, credentials, breach, quarantine, firewall, protocol

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
Corporate Cybersecurity Incident Alert
Incident Ref: SEC-2026-088. Yesterday at 14:20, a finance employee clicked a spoofed executive invoice
attachment, initiating an unauthorized credential harvesting script on corporate subnet B. Automated intrusion
defenses triggered immediate system isolation. File the official incident report.

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

Strategy: Write in an objective, technical register. Follow a strict timeline: Incident Context, Chronology, Immediate Containment, Remedial Actions.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** cybersecurity, phishing, malware, credentials

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Incident Report • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Incident Report response below (150 and 250 words):

6

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 300 WORDS

Format 6: Advice Leaflet



Professional context for Advice Leaflet.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Young adults and school leavers. Tone / Formality: Helpful, encouraging, clear, and instructive. Specialist words: budget, essential expenditure, emergency fund, direct debit, debt, interest, confidential

Expected Tone & Register: Helpful, encouraging, clear, and instructive. Specialist words: budget, essential expenditure, emergency fund, direct debit, debt, interest, confidential

Essential Format Features: Engaging title, welcoming introduction, clear subheadings, bullet points with advice verbs (Set up, Avoid, Calculate), clear helpline/contact details at the bottom.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: budget, essential expenditure, emergency fund, direct debit, debt, interest.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 21 MARKS

TASK

Advice Leaflet • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 6

Context & Stimulus Material:
Your local Citizens Advice Bureau is launching an outreach initiative aimed at young adults and school leavers
entitled "Smart Budgeting: Managing Your First Wages".
They have asked you to write the copy for an advice leaflet. Common challenges reported: • overspending
on credit cards and "Buy Now Pay Later" schemes
• unexpected utility and mobile phone bills
• having no emergency savings.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- explain the importance of planning income versus essential expenditure
- give practical tips on cutting daily costs and avoiding high-interest debt

Word Count Target: 250 and 300 words **Marks:** 21 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Advice Leaflet • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Advice Leaflet

Smart Budgeting: How to Make Your First Wages Last! Starting your first job and earning your own wages is exciting! However, without a clear plan, money can disappear very quickly. Follow these easy steps to manage your money successfully. Know Your Numbers: Income vs. Expenses Before spending on entertainment or clothes, calculate your essential expenditure . This includes rent, transport, food, and bills. Follow the 50/30/20 rule: spend 50% on essentials, 30% on fun, and save 20%. Set up a direct debit for regular bills so you never miss a payment. Build an emergency fund in a separate savings account for unexpected costs. Smart Ways to Cut Daily Costs Small changes in your daily routine add up to big savings each month: Prepare lunch and coffee at home rather than buying them every workday. Cancel subscription services and memberships you rarely use. Avoid buy-now-pay-later schemes and credit cards. They charge high interest if you miss payments, which leads to heavy debt . Where to Get Free Advice If you are worried about money, you do not have to struggle alone. You can get free, friendly, and confidential advice from trained specialists.

Visit Citizens Advice online or call National Debtline on 0808 808 4000 (freephone). Take control of your money today!

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **budget:** a plan of how much money you receive and how essential expenditure

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 21 MARKS • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Advice Leaflet • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario & Context: Understanding Employment Contracts, Statutory Rights & Wellbeing Audience & Tone: Young adults, apprentices, and college leavers entering the workforce (Authoritative, empowering, and accessible). Specialist words: statutory, national minimum wage, probation, entitlement, dispute resolution, union, wellbeing • Young adults, apprentices, and college leavers entering the workforce (Authoritative, empowering, and accessible). Specialist words: statutory, national minimum wage, probation, entitlement, dispute resolution, union, wellbeing

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
National Youth Employment Advisory Brief
"Young workers frequently enter their first roles unaware of statutory contract entitlements, unpaid overtime
traps, or how to resolve workplace grievances. Produce an authoritative guide titled 'Know Your Rights: A Young
Worker's Essential Employment Handbook'."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

Strategy: Structure the leaflet with clear, authoritative subheadings and bullet points. Use direct second-person address ('you') balanced with statutory accuracy.

Target: 250 and 350 words • **Key Words:** statutory, national minimum wage, probation, entitlement

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 250 AND 350 WORDS

Advice Leaflet • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Advice Leaflet response below (250 and 350 words):

7

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 200 AND 260 WORDS

Format 7: Review



Professional context for Review.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Readers of a local community lifestyle and leisure website. Tone / Formality: Informative, honest, balanced, and evaluative. Specialist words: facilities, membership, atmosphere, induction, affordable, peak hours, recommend

Expected Tone & Register: Informative, honest, balanced, and evaluative. Specialist words: facilities, membership, atmosphere, induction, affordable, peak hours, recommend

Essential Format Features: Clear Title naming the venue, star rating / overall verdict, specific category evaluation (equipment, staff, value), balanced pros and cons, clear concluding recommendation.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: facilities, membership, atmosphere, induction, affordable, peak hours.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

TASK

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

Review • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 7

Context & Stimulus Material:
You recently visited a newly opened local community gym and fitness centre called Pinnacle Fitness.
Features observed:
• Equipment: Brand-new cardio machines, good weights; studio is cramped during peak classes.
• Staff: Friendly and qualified trainers, welcoming induction session.
• Value: £28 per month with no contract; off-peak student discounts. Booking app sometimes crashes.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- give your overall impression and a clear rating
- state who this gym is most suitable for and whether you recommend it.

Word Count Target: 200 and 260 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Review • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Review

Pinnacle Fitness: Great Value Gym with Minor Teething Issues Rating: ★★★★☆ (4/5 Stars) | Reviewed by: Jordan Evans I recently visited the newly opened Pinnacle Fitness on High Street to test their facilities, and overall, I had a very positive experience. Modern Equipment and Clean Facilities The gym floor is clean and spacious, featuring brand-new running machines, exercise bikes, and a well-stocked free-weights zone. The changing rooms and showers were spotless during my visit. Helpful Staff and Welcoming Atmosphere The customer service was excellent. During my first visit, a trainer provided a detailed safety induction and helped me build an exercise routine. Staff are always polite and approachable. Areas for Improvement However, there are two issues. Firstly, during peak hours between 5:30 pm and 7:30 pm, the fitness studio is too crowded. Secondly, the mobile app used to book classes crashed twice. Value and Final Verdict At £28 per month with no long-term contract, this gym offers an affordable membership . It is particularly great for beginners and students. Despite small technical problems, I fully recommend Pinnacle Fitness to local residents.

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **facilities:** the rooms, showers, and equipment provided at a atmosphere

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Review • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: Enterprise Project Management Software ('TaskFlow Pro') Audience & Tone: Remote team leaders and SaaS tech review readers (Discerning, analytical, and professional). Specialist words: user interface, integration, workflow, functionality, subscription, efficiency, cross-platform • Remote team leaders and SaaS tech review readers (Discerning, analytical, and professional). Specialist words: user interface, integration, workflow, functionality, subscription, efficiency, cross-platform

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
SaaS & Workplace Tech Review Portal
"Software Spotlight: Review an enterprise collaborative platform (e.g., TaskFlow Pro). Evaluate user onboarding,
calendar synchronization, task dependency tracking, pricing tiers, and real-world utility for agile
multidisciplinary teams."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- evaluate two outstanding functional strengths (e.g. intuitive Kanban boards, automated status updates)
- conclude with a decisive rating out of 5 stars and identify which organizational profiles would derive

Strategy: Provide a nuanced, expert critique. Balance technical praise with legitimate performance limitations before awarding stars.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** user interface, integration, workflow, functionality

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Review • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Review response below (150 and 250 words):

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 180 AND 230 WORDS

8 Format 8: Online Feedback Form



Professional context for Online Feedback Form.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Customer Services / Retailer support team. Tone / Formality: Polite, direct, formal, and objective. Specialist words: order reference, delivery, damaged, replacement, inconvenience, resolve, refund

Expected Tone & Register: Polite, direct, formal, and objective. Specialist words: order reference, delivery, damaged, replacement, inconvenience, resolve, refund

Essential Format Features: Form reference headers (Order Ref, Customer Name, Date), clear and direct reason for writing, objective breakdown of delivery and product defects, impact statement, specific resolution requested.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: order reference, delivery, damaged, replacement, inconvenience, resolve.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

TASK

Online Feedback Form • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 8

Context & Stimulus Material:
You recently ordered a desk and ergonomic chair from the online retailer HomeOffice Direct (Order ref: #HD-88412).
• Courier arrived without the promised 1-hour tracking notification.
• Outer box was torn, leaving a scratch on the desk corner.
• Assembly screws and bolts for the ergonomic chair were missing.
The company features a structured Customer Feedback Form.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- evaluate both the delivery service and the condition of the goods received
- describe the inconvenience caused to your work setup

Word Count Target: 180 and 230 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Online Feedback Form • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Online Feedback Form

Form highlighted

Customer Feedback Form: HomeOffice Direct Customer Name: Maria Santos | Order Reference : #HD-88412 Product: Desk and Ergonomic Chair Set | Date of Delivery: 1st September 2026

Reason for Feedback: I am submitting this form to report poor delivery service and damaged items received with my recent order. Details of Issues: Firstly, the delivery driver arrived without sending the promised 1-hour tracking text, meaning I was almost unavailable to accept the parcels. Upon unpacking the goods, I found that the desk corner was scratched because the packaging had torn during transit. More importantly, the bag containing the assembly bolts for the office chair was missing entirely. Impact and Inconvenience: Because I cannot assemble the chair or use the damaged desk, I cannot work comfortably from home this week. This has caused serious inconvenience to my job. Action Required: To resolve this issue, please send a packet of replacement chair bolts by express courier. Furthermore, I request a £35 partial refund to cover the damage to the desk. I look forward to receiving your response within 48 hours.

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **order reference:** a unique tracking number given to an delivery
- **s order address damaged:** broken, scratched, or harmed in some way inconvenience
- **s plans resolve:** to find an acceptable solution to a complaint replacement

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

TASK

Online Feedback Form • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: Severe Flight Cancellation, Stranded Passengers & Delayed Baggage Audience & Tone: Airline Executive Customer Relations Department (Assertive, legally grounded, and uncompromising). Specialist words: compensation, statutory rights, accommodation, negligence, baggage delay, expenses, reimbursement • Airline Executive Customer Relations Department (Assertive, legally grounded, and uncompromising). Specialist words: compensation, statutory rights, accommodation, negligence, baggage delay, expenses, reimbursement

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
SkyLink Airways Executive Customer Relations
"Booking Reference: SK-904128 | Flight: SK402 (London to Edinburgh) | Date: 12 July | Please document your
service grievance, detailing ground staff handling, accommodation failure, out-of-pocket expenses, and
compensation claimed under UK261 regulations."

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

Strategy: Cite legal passenger entitlements (UK261) dispassionately. Itemize losses with exact monetary figures to compel restitution.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** compensation, statutory rights, accommodation, negligence

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Online Feedback Form • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Online Feedback Form response below (150 and 250 words):

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 220 AND 280 WORDS

9 Format 9: Online Forum / Blog Post



Photo

photo coming soon

Professional context for Online Forum / Blog Post.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Online community members, students, and job seekers. Tone / Formality: Conversational, thoughtful, supportive, and semi-formal. Specialist words: apprenticeship, qualifications, student debt, practical experience, tuition fees, career path, perspectives

Expected Tone & Register: Conversational, thoughtful, supportive, and semi-formal. Specialist words: apprenticeship, qualifications, student debt, practical experience, tuition fees, career path, perspectives

Essential Format Features: Thread title, author and date line, friendly community greeting, balanced comparison of options, personal reflection, closing question inviting replies.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: apprenticeship, qualifications, student debt, practical experience, tuition fees, career path.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

TASK

Online Forum / Blog Post • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 9

Context & Stimulus Material:
You read the following thread on an educational forum called NextSteps Careers:
Thread: Is University Still Worth the Investment?
Posted by: CareerSeeker24
"With rising tuition fees and the availability of degree apprenticeships, is going to university still the best choice
for young people today? I'd love to hear different experiences!"

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

Word Count Target: 220 and 280 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Online Forum / Blog Post • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Online Forum / Blog Post

Post highlighted

Thread: Is University Still Worth the Investment? | Post by: Maya_Learner Hi CareerSeeker24 and everyone, This is a fantastic question that many learners are asking today. Both routes offer distinct advantages depending on your career goals. Going to university is still essential if you want to enter careers like medicine, teaching, or law. University provides higher academic qualifications and independence. However, high tuition fees mean graduates often leave university with huge student debt , without any guarantee of an immediate job. In contrast, an apprenticeship has become an extremely attractive option. You earn a wage while learning, avoid tuition debt, and gain valuable practical experience in an actual workplace. A friend of mine completed a digital marketing apprenticeship two years ago; she is now in a permanent management role with no debt, whereas many graduates are still searching for work. From my own perspectives , you should think about how you prefer to learn. If you enjoy hands-on practical work and want financial independence early, an apprenticeship is ideal. But if your chosen career path requires a degree, university remains a worthwhile investment. What do others on this forum think about degree apprenticeships? I would love to read your comments!

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **qualifications:** official certificates showing you have passed tuition fees

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

TASK

Online Forum / Blog Post • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: The Four-Day Working Week: Operational Miracle or Logistical Mirage? Audience & Tone: HR professionals, executives, and remote workers (*Future Workplace Network*). Specialist words: productivity, burnout, work-life balance, compressed hours, retention, feasibility, output • HR professionals, executives, and remote workers (*Future Workplace Network*). Specialist words: productivity, burnout, work-life balance, compressed hours, retention, feasibility, output

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
Future Workplace Network Discussion Thread
"Thread: 'The 4-Day Working Week: Miracle or Myth?' Host post by @WorkplaceVision: 'Global trials suggest
100% output in 80% time reduces staff burnout by 70%. Yet operational leaders warn client coverage suffers
and 10-hour days exhaust workers. Is a shorter week actually viable across all sectors?'"

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- examine the compelling mental health and employee retention dividends evidenced in commercial trials
- propose a flexible staggered-team compromise and invite fellow industry professionals to share operational

Strategy: Combine intellectual rigour with an engaging digital style. End with an open-ended question that sparks peer dialogue.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** productivity, burnout, work-life balance, compressed hours

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Online Forum / Blog Post • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Online Forum / Blog Post response below (150 and 250 words):

10

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 230 AND 280 WORDS

Format 10: Newsletter



Professional context for Newsletter.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Community volunteers, local supporters, and sponsors. Tone / Formality: Enthusiastic, welcoming, informative, and community-focused. Specialist words: harvest, donation, sensory garden, volunteers, funding, community, upcoming

Expected Tone & Register: Enthusiastic, welcoming, informative, and community-focused. Specialist words: harvest, donation, sensory garden, volunteers, funding, community, upcoming

Essential Format Features: Eye-catching newsletter title banner, issue number & date, punchy section headings, celebratory community tone, bullet points for key facts, call to action with contact email.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: harvest, donation, sensory garden, volunteers, funding, community.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

TASK

Newsletter • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 10

Context & Stimulus Material:
You are a volunteer coordinator for St. Jude's Community Garden Project. You are preparing the quarterly
newsletter sent to all supporters and volunteers.
• Summer Harvest: Over 350 kg of organic vegetables donated to the local food bank.
• Sensory Garden: National Lottery funding secured; volunteer digging day on Saturday 18th October.
• Appeal: Looking for volunteer drivers on Tuesday mornings and garden tool donations.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- give details about the upcoming volunteer planting day
- explain how readers can volunteer their time or donate equipment.

Word Count Target: 230 and 280 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Newsletter • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Newsletter

🌱 St. Jude's Green Gazette Issue 14 | Autumn 2026 | Community Garden Newsletter Welcome to our autumn newsletter! It has been a wonderful summer, and we want to say a huge thank you to all our dedicated volunteers and local supporters. Record-Breaking Summer Harvest! Thanks to your hard work, we enjoyed our most successful harvest ever. We grew over 350 kg of fresh vegetables, including potatoes, carrots, and tomatoes. All the produce was given as a fresh food donation to the Greendale Food Bank, feeding over 60 local families. Exciting News: New Sensory Garden We are delighted to announce that we received National Lottery funding to build a sensory garden with scented flowers and raised beds for wheelchair users. Our upcoming Community Digging Day is on Saturday 18th October, from 10:00 am to 3:00 pm. Free hot drinks and lunch will be provided for all helpers! How You Can Support Us We urgently need volunteer drivers on Tuesday mornings to deliver vegetables. In addition, we would welcome donations of spare garden forks, spades, or watering cans. If you can help our community project, please email us at volunteer@stjudesgarden.org.uk. Let's keep growing together!

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **volunteers:** people who give their time to do work without harvest

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Newsletter • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: Corporate Sustainability Milestone & Annual Volunteering Week Audience & Tone: All corporate employees, management, and charity partners (*The Horizon*). Specialist words: sustainability, carbon offset, volunteering, biodiversity, initiative, partnership, milestone • All corporate employees, management, and charity partners (*The Horizon*). Specialist words: sustainability, carbon offset, volunteering, biodiversity, initiative, partnership, milestone

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
Internal Communications Staff Newsletter Brief
"Draft the lead article for the autumn edition of The Horizon (staff newsletter). Celebrate our company-wide
achievement of reducing landfill waste by 40%, announce our upcoming Charity Volunteer Days, and launch the
inter-departmental energy challenge." — Corporate Affairs Lead

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

Strategy: Infuse the article with pride and momentum. Use vibrant subheadings and bullet points to maximize reader engagement.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** sustainability, carbon offset, volunteering, biodiversity

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Newsletter • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Newsletter response below (150 and 250 words):

FORMAT BLUEPRINT • 15 MARKS • 200 AND 250 WORDS

11 Format 11: Diary / Reflective Entry



Professional context for Diary / Reflective Entry.

Structural Architecture & Key Layout Conventions

Target Audience: Personal reflective portfolio and vocational course tutor. Tone / Formality: Honest, reflective, personal, and professional. Specialist words: placement, anxious, confidence, professional, mentoring, actively listening, objectives

Expected Tone & Register: Honest, reflective, personal, and professional. Specialist words: placement, anxious, confidence, professional, mentoring, actively listening, objectives

Essential Format Features: Date and time entry, first-person reflective voice ('I felt', 'I learned'), chronological reflection on challenges and successes, specific learning breakthrough, two clear professional goals for the future.

Band 4 Vocabulary Strategy

Integrate specialist vocabulary: placement, anxious, confidence, professional, mentoring, actively listening.

Examiner Guidance

Read all bullet points before you begin. Spend 5 minutes planning your paragraphs and vocabulary. Turn over for the model answer.

PEARSON EDEXCEL SCENARIO • 15 MARKS

TASK

Diary / Reflective Entry • Examination Task

Official Exam Brief • Format 11

Context & Stimulus Material:
As part of your Level 2 vocational course, you have completed the first week of a work placement at Metro
Tech Support. Your tutor requires a Reflective Diary Entry evaluating your progress.
• Days 1 & 2: Felt anxious, struggled with telephone calls, found database confusing.
• Days 3 & 4: Senior colleague mentored you; confidence grew; answered queries independently.
• Key lesson: Dealing with an angry client taught you the power of calm, active listening.

Task Instructions: Write your response for the specified audience. In your writing, you must:

- describe a specific situation where you demonstrated skill improvement or problem-solving

Word Count Target: 200 and 250 words **Marks:** 15 Marks

TAP Planning Framework (Text, Audience, Purpose)

Audience & Register:	Key Discourse Markers:	Specialist Vocabulary:
Formal / Semi-formal	Furthermore, In contrast	3+ domain words

✎ Candidate Paragraph Outline (Intro • Point 1 • Point 2 • Conclusion)

MODEL

EXAMINER BENCHMARK EXEMPLAR • FULL MARKS

Diary / Reflective Entry • Band 4 Model Answer

Band 4 Exemplar: Diary / Reflective Entry

Entry highlighted

Friday, 4th September 2026 | 17:30 Work Placement Diary: Week 1 Reflection (Metro Tech Support) Looking back at my first week, I am pleased with how much progress I have made. On Monday and Tuesday, I felt very anxious . The office was fast-paced, and I found the database software difficult to use. Answering customer calls made me nervous because I feared giving incorrect technical advice. Fortunately, things improved on Wednesday when David, a senior technician, offered me some mentoring . He sat with me, explained the booking software clearly, and taught me how to keep a calm, professional tone on the phone. This support gave my confidence a huge boost. My biggest breakthrough happened on Thursday afternoon when an upset customer called because his laptop had crashed. Instead of panicking, I focused on actively listening without interrupting. I reassured him politely and booked a repair slot. The customer thanked me warmly for my help. For Week 2, I have set two clear objectives : 1. Log customer support tickets independently without checking with my supervisor. 2. Shadow the network technicians during equipment installations. This week was challenging, but I am proud of my progress!

Specialist Vocabulary in this Model Answer:

- **placement:** a temporary period of work experience taken anxious

✎ Examiner Commentary: Key High-Yield Structural & Lexical Devices

TASK

UNSEEN EXAMINATION TASK • 15 MARKS • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Diary / Reflective Entry • Practice Task Brief

Examination Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario & Context: Leading a Cross-Departmental Project Meeting under Conflict
Audience & Tone: Professional leadership journal / Management apprenticeship assessor. Specialist words: facilitation, consensus, conflict management, interpersonal, agenda, active listening, resolution • Professional leadership journal / Management apprenticeship assessor. Specialist words: facilitation, consensus, conflict management, interpersonal, agenda, active listening, resolution

Context & Stimulus:
You review this documentation / background brief:
Management Leadership Portfolio Brief
"Reflective Practice Log #6: Critically evaluate an occasion where you chaired a project meeting characterised
by conflicting stakeholder priorities. Apply a reflective model (e.g. Gibbs) to examine your emotional responses,
facilitation technique, and future leadership adaptations." — Leadership Assessor

Task Instructions: In your writing, you must:

- analyze your internal emotional reactions and critique how you intervened during heated disagreements
- evaluate which facilitation strategies succeeded (e.g. enforcing the agenda) and where your leadership

Strategy: Demonstrate deep metacognition and emotional intelligence. Evaluate both internal anxieties and external communication dynamics.

Target: 150 and 250 words • **Key Words:** facilitation, consensus, conflict management, interpersonal

✎ Candidate TAP Planning & Paragraph Outlines (Intro • Main Body • Action Close)

OFFICIAL LINED ASSESSMENT PAGE • 150 AND 250 WORDS

Diary / Reflective Entry • Candidate Response

✎ Write your Diary / Reflective Entry response below (150 and 250 words):

S1

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

SPaG Masterclass 1: Sentence Demarcation & Semicolons

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Eliminate comma splices by replacing commas between independent clauses with a semicolon or full stop.

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Use a semicolon to connect two complete thoughts that are closely related.

! Common Exam Error

Never use a comma by itself to join two independent clauses (comma splice).

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 1)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 1 • Calibration Drill

Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (4 Items)

Calibration Task: Rewrite each sentence using an appropriate semicolon (;) or full stop followed by a capital letter.

1. The delivery arrived two hours late, the frozen goods had already started to thaw.

2. The morning shift completed their inventory audit, the evening shift still needs to tally the damaged stock.

3. Customer complaints have surged this month, the management team must review our telephone response times.

4. All staff must attend the fire drill tomorrow, attendance is compulsory for permanent and agency employees.

✎ Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

S2

SPaG Masterclass 2: Subordinating Conjunctions & Complex Sentences

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Join clauses using subordinating conjunctions: although, whereas, unless, while, provided that.

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Start complex sentences with 'Although' or 'While' to create sophisticated contrast.

! Common Exam Error

When the subordinate clause comes first, always place a comma after it.

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 2)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 2 • Calibration Drill

Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (4 Items)

Calibration Task: Combine each pair of simple sentences into a sophisticated complex sentence using the specified subordinating conjunctions.

1. The warehouse was exceptionally busy. The dispatch team met every delivery target.

2. Agency drivers will not be permitted on site. They must complete the mandatory safety briefing first.

3. Electric vehicles require higher initial capital investment. Their running costs are significantly lower.

4. Staff may request hybrid working. They must maintain their weekly performance targets.

✎ Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

S3

SPaG Masterclass 3: Active vs Passive Voice in Workplace Writing

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Transform informal active blame into objective, professional passive phrasing suitable for official reports.

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Use passive voice in incident reports to remain objective and avoid finger-pointing.

! Common Exam Error

Do not overuse passive voice where active responsibility is required.

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 3)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 3 • Calibration Drill

▶ Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (4 Items)

Calibration Task: Rewrite each statement in the professional passive voice to focus objectively on actions, causes, and impacts.

1. **Jordan dropped a pallet of glass bottles because he was rushing his forklift.**
2. **Someone forgot to lock the chemical cabinet before leaving the laboratory.**
3. **The maintenance contractor didn't inspect the elevator cables last Friday.**
4. **Our receptionists gave incorrect appointment times to four dental patients.**

✎ Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):

S4

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

SPaG Masterclass 4: Modal Verbs & Professional Hedging

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Calibrate certainty with precision: replace aggressive absolutes with appropriate modal verbs (could, should, is likely to).

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Use modal verbs (could, may, should) to express diplomatic workplace suggestions.

! Common Exam Error

Avoid aggressive or absolute phrasing like 'must immediately' or 'will fail'.

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 4)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 4 • Calibration Drill

Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (4 Items)

Calibration Task: Rewrite each blunt or exaggerated statement using professional modal hedging suitable for an executive briefing.

1. **If we don't buy new laptops right now, the entire department will fail.**
2. **The client is definitely lying about when they sent the payment cheque.**
3. **Installing solar panels will completely eliminate all our energy bills forever.**
4. **The new shift rota is going to make all staff quit within a month.**

✎ **Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):**

S5

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

SPaG Masterclass 5: Parallel Structure in Bulleted Lists

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Ensure all bullet items start with matching grammatical forms (e.g. all imperative verbs or all gerunds).

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Begin all bullet points with matching grammatical forms (e.g. all imperative verbs).

! Common Exam Error

Never switch between nouns, verbs, and questions within the same bullet list.

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 5)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 5 • Calibration Drill

▶ Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (1 Items)

Calibration Task: Rewrite the bulleted list so that every single point starts consistently with an active imperative verb.

**Review the mixed list below for an incident response plan:
• Sounding the alarm immediately upon detecting smoke.
• You must escort all visitors to Assembly Point C.
• Do not re-enter the facility until given clearance.
• Checking the toilets and meeting rooms for stranded personnel.**

✎ Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

S6

SPaG Masterclass 6: Apostrophes of Possession & Omission

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Correct apostrophe misuse: distinguish singular possession, plural possession, irregular plurals, and its vs it's.

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Check whether an apostrophe shows ownership (singular vs plural) or missing letters.

! Common Exam Error

Remember that possessive 'its' has NO apostrophe (it's = it is or it has).

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 6)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 6 • Calibration Drill

Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (4 Items)

Calibration Task: Identify every misplaced or missing apostrophe in the sentences above and rewrite them correctly.

1. The nurses union submitted it's formal petition to the hospital directors office.

2. All client files must be returned to the managers desk before the day's end.

3. The company announced its new policy regarding childrens nursery vouchers.

4. Both driver's vehicles were damaged when the warehouse roof lost it's guttering.

✎ Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

S7

SPaG Masterclass 7: Discourse Markers & Paragraph Linking

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Use sophisticated cohesive devices: Furthermore, Consequently, In contrast, Nevertheless, As a result.

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Use diverse discourse markers (Furthermore, Consequently, In contrast) to link paragraphs.

! Common Exam Error

Avoid starting every paragraph with simplistic connectives like 'Also' or 'And'.

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 7)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 7 • Calibration Drill

Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (1 Items)

Calibration Task: Re-write the extract into a fluent paragraph using at least three distinct discourse markers.

**Connect this fragmented report extract into a unified paragraph:
The facility experienced an unexpected power outage at 08:30. The backup generators activated within thirty seconds. The IT server room sustained no data loss. The automated packing conveyor lines shut down temporarily. Staff had to pack customer parcels manually until power was restored.**

✎ **Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):**

ADVANCED SYNTAX • BAND 4 SPAG

S8

SPaG Masterclass 8: Formal Vocabulary & Nominalisation

★ Syntax Rule & Examination Benchmark

Raise the register of your writing by transforming verbs and casual adjectives into formal executive nouns.

✓ High-Yield SPaG Rule

Transform verbs and adjectives into executive nouns (nominalisation) to elevate register.

! Common Exam Error

Avoid conversational idioms and colloquial slang in formal reports.

✎ Key Sentence Templates & Transformational Rules (Unit 8)

DRILL

APPLIED WORKPLACE SENTENCE PRACTICE

SPaG Masterclass 8 • Calibration Drill

▶ Workplace Sentences to Calibrate (4 Items)

Calibration Task: Rewrite each colloquial statement into formal executive prose using nominalisation and sophisticated vocabulary.

1. We need to look into how much money we're wasting on paper every week.

2. When workers get fed up with their bosses, they don't work as hard.

3. We tried out the new booking website and it was really clunky and annoying.

4. The manager told everyone off because people kept turning up late for shifts.

✎ Write your calibrated responses below (refer to reference answers on p81):

MOCK 1

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 2 SIMULATION • 60 MINUTES • 36 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Examination • Paper 1

Examination Regulations & Timing Guidance

Instructions to Candidates:

- Total time: **60 minutes**. Total marks: **36 marks**.
- You must complete **BOTH** tasks: Task 1 (21 marks, 250–350 words) and Task 2 (15 marks, 200–250 words).
- Use an English dictionary and spellchecker if completing on-screen.
- Plan your time carefully: spend 35 minutes on Task 1 and 25 minutes on Task 2.
- Check all work carefully: 41.7% of marks are awarded for Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar.

Time Strategy

Spend 5 minutes planning paragraph outlines and vocabulary before writing.

Pacing Warning

Do not spend more than 35 minutes on Task 1, or you will run out of time for Task 2.

✎ Pre-Exam Readiness Notes & Mindset Checklist

TASK 1 (EXTENDED WRITING) • 21 MARKS • 250–350 WORDS

T1

Mock 1 • Task 1: Formal Proposal Letter • Community Healthcare Grant

Task 1 Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: You are an administrative coordinator at a community health clinic in an urban borough. The Regional Health Trust has announced a £5,000 community investment grant to fund grassroots facility improvements. Write a formal proposal letter to the Trust Director, Dr Angela Simmons, proposing how your clinic would utilize this funding.

- Explain specific accessibility and physical access barriers currently experienced by patients at your clinic.
- Detail two distinct initiatives the £5,000 grant would finance and how each will be implemented.
- Outline how the clinical team will evaluate the success of the improvements over the next twelve months.

Recommended Time: 35 Minutes **Target:** 250–350 words

✎ Task 1 Planning Matrix (Audience • Register • Paragraph Outlines • Vocabulary)

OFFICIAL LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 21 MARKS

Mock 1 • Task 1 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 1 response below (250–350 words):

TASK 2 (STRUCTURED WRITING) • 15 MARKS • 200–250 WORDS

T2 Mock 1 • Task 2: Informative & Persuasive Article • Electric Urban Travel

Task 2 Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: A regional lifestyle and motoring magazine is publishing a special issue titled 'Urban Travel in 2030'. Many motorists are anxious about moving away from petrol and diesel cars. Write an engaging, balanced article evaluating whether electric vehicles and public charging networks are ready for everyday family use.

- Evaluate the practical and financial advantages of switching to electric vehicles.
- Address genuine public concerns regarding charging infrastructure, range, and battery lifespan.
- Provide a clear, balanced conclusion advising motorists on whether now is the right time to transition.

Recommended Time: 25 Minutes **Target:** 200–250 words

✎ Task 2 Planning Matrix (Audience • Register • Key Points • Vocabulary)

OFFICIAL LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 15 MARKS

Mock 1 • Task 2 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 2 response below (200–250 words):

AUDIT

SELF-EVALUATION & MARK SCHEME ALIGNMENT

Mock 1 • Candidate Post-Exam Audit

Post-Mock Verification Checklist

Audit your Mock 1 responses against Pearson criteria before consulting the model answers on p86:

- **Word Count Audit:** Did you hit 250–350 words on Task 1 and 200–250 words on Task 2?
- **Coverage:** Did you address every single bullet point in both tasks?
- **Punctuation Check:** Are all sentences demarcated correctly? Have you eliminated all comma splices?
- **Discourse Markers:** Did you use a range of linking phrases (Consequently, However, In addition)?

✎ Personal Reflections & Weaknesses Identified in Mock 1

MOCK 2

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 2 SIMULATION • 60 MINUTES • 36 MARKS

Official Mock Writing Examination • Paper 2

Mock Paper 2 Briefing

Examination Instructions: Complete both Task 1 (21 marks) and Task 2 (15 marks). Total time is 60 minutes. Apply the Band 4 principles learned throughout the guide.

Executive Register

Keep your register strictly professional throughout.

Vocabulary Diversity

Watch out for repetitive vocabulary; use a thesaurus or specialist term list.

✎ Candidate Target Milestones for Mock 2

TASK 1 (EXTENDED WRITING) • 21 MARKS • 250–350 WORDS

T1

Mock 2 • Task 1: Workplace Incident & Safety Investigation Report

Task 1 Brief • 21 Marks

Scenario: You are the Senior Logistics Team Leader at Apex Express Distribution Hub in Leeds. On Tuesday morning at 10:15 am, a serious near-miss and forklift collision occurred in Loading Bay C: a forklift truck dislodged four pallets of consumer electronics, causing them to topple across a pedestrian walkway. Operative David Clarke suffered a sprained wrist. Write an official investigation report to Regional Operations Director Mr Robert Keane.

- Provide an objective factual account of the collision, including date, time, location, and equipment involved.
- Analyze the human, training, and physical site factors that contributed to the incident.
- Recommend three mandatory preventative safety measures with assigned deadlines to prevent a recurrence.

Recommended Time: 35 Minutes **Target:** 250–350 words

✎ Task 1 Planning Matrix (Audience • Register • Facts • Actions)

OFFICIAL LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 21 MARKS

Mock 2 • Task 1 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 1 response below (250–350 words):

TASK 2 (STRUCTURED WRITING) • 15 MARKS • 200–250 WORDS

T2 Mock 2 • Task 2: Persuasive Article for Regional Business Journal

Task 2 Brief • 15 Marks

Scenario: The Yorkshire Business Review has invited opinion pieces on solving the national technical skills crisis. While some business executives complain that training apprentices is too expensive and time-consuming, others credit apprenticeships with business growth. Write a persuasive article arguing why investing in modern apprenticeships is vital for regional industry.

- Analyze the causes and corporate costs of persistent skill shortages in modern industry.
- Present compelling arguments demonstrating how apprenticeships reduce employee turnover and enhance productivity.
- Conclude with a persuasive call to action urging corporate leaders to commit to vocational training.

Recommended Time: 25 Minutes **Target:** 200–250 words

✎ Task 2 Planning Matrix (Headline • Subheadings • Persuasive Devices)

OFFICIAL LINED RESPONSE BOOKLET • 15 MARKS

Mock 2 • Task 2 Candidate Response

✎ Write your Task 2 response below (200–250 words):

AUDIT

SELF-EVALUATION & MARK SCHEME ALIGNMENT

Mock 2 • Candidate Post-Exam Audit

Mock 2 Quality Audit

Review your Mock 2 scripts before checking the benchmark answers on p90:

- **Format Precision:** Are all required structural markers present and clearly formatted?
- **Sentence Architecture:** Have you used a balanced mix of simple, compound, and complex sentences?
- **Specialist Register:** Did you incorporate accurate, high-register domain vocabulary?

✎ Personal Reflections & Final Commitments for Real Exam

RUBRIC

PEARSON EDEXCEL BAND 1–4 ASSESSMENT GRID • 12 MARKS

Official Marking Criteria • Task 1 Composition

Task 1: Form, Audience, Purpose & Cohesion (12 Marks)

Band 4 (10–12 marks): Text is fully fit for purpose and audience. Register and tone are consistently sophisticated and appropriate. Information is logically sequenced with complex paragraphs and diverse discourse markers. All bullet points are comprehensively developed with rich supporting detail and justified arguments.

Band 3 (7–9 marks): Text is fit for purpose and audience. Tone and format are appropriate with minor lapses. Paragraphs are clear and structured with topic sentences and linking devices. All bullet points are addressed with appropriate detail and relevant supporting ideas.

Band 2 (4–6 marks): Text is partially fit for purpose. Register may be inconsistent or too informal. Paragraphing is attempted but ideas may wander. Bullet points are partially addressed; some points lack development or clarity.

Band 1 (1–3 marks): Text shows limited awareness of purpose and audience. Little or no paragraphing. Bullet points are omitted or only briefly mentioned. Meaning is frequently unclear.

✎ Personal Strategy to Guarantee Band 4 on Task 1 Composition

RUBRIC

PEARSON EDEXCEL BAND 1–3 ASSESSMENT GRID • 9 MARKS

Official Marking Criteria • Task 1 SPaG

Task 1: Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (9 Marks)

Band 3 (7–9 marks): Punctuation is consistently accurate across a wide range (full stops, capital letters, commas in clauses, semicolons, colons, apostrophes). Spelling is accurate, including complex, irregular, and specialist words. Grammar is secure; complex sentences are managed with varied clauses and consistent tense.

Band 2 (4–6 marks): Punctuation is mostly accurate for basic sentence demarcation (full stops, capitals); some errors with commas or apostrophes. Spelling of common and everyday words is accurate; occasional errors with specialist vocabulary. Grammar is generally sound with some tense or agreement slips.

Band 1 (1–3 marks): Punctuation is frequently omitted or inaccurate (run-on sentences, comma splices). Frequent spelling errors hinder meaning. Grammar errors in basic subject-verb agreement and tense.

✎ Punctuation & Spelling Audit Commitments

PEARSON EDEXCEL BAND 1–3 ASSESSMENT GRID • 9 MARKS

RUBRIC

Official Marking Criteria • Task 2 Composition

Task 2: Form, Audience, Purpose & Cohesion (9 Marks)

Band 3 (7–9 marks): Content is fully relevant and engaging for the specified audience. Format conventions (subject lines, bullet points, salutations) are accurately implemented. Logical structure with fluent transitions between points. All prompt requirements are thoroughly met within the target word count.

Band 2 (4–6 marks): Content is mostly relevant with an appropriate tone. Main format conventions are present. Paragraphs separate distinct points. Most prompt requirements are addressed with sufficient detail.

Band 1 (1–3 marks): Content has limited relevance or inappropriate tone. Key format markers are missing. Disorganised structure. Prompt requirements are largely ignored or superficially treated.

✎ Personal Strategy to Guarantee Band 3 on Task 2 Composition

RUBRIC

PEARSON EDEXCEL BAND 1–3 ASSESSMENT GRID • 6 MARKS

Official Marking Criteria • Task 2 SPaG

Task 2: Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar (6 Marks)

Band 3 (5–6 marks): High level of SPaG accuracy. Accurate complex punctuation, accurate specialist spelling, and sophisticated sentence structures.

Band 2 (3–4 marks): Sound SPaG accuracy. Basic punctuation secure; minor slips in complex structures or specialist spelling.

Band 1 (1–2 marks): Persistent SPaG errors in basic sentence boundaries, common spelling, and simple syntax.

✎ Final Self-Audit Rules for Task 2 SPaG

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX

Complete Worked Solutions, Lexicon & Alphabetical Index

SPAG MASTERCLASS 1: SENTENCE DEMARCATION & SEMICOLONS

1 The delivery arrived two hours late; consequently, the frozen goods had already started to thaw. **[1]**

Semicolon or period to separate independent clauses; eliminates comma splice.

2 The morning shift completed their inventory audit; the evening shift still needs to tally the damaged stock. **[1]**

Semicolon links two closely related clauses without a conjunction.

3 Customer complaints have surged this month; therefore, the management team must review our telephone response times. **[1]**

Semicolon followed by conjunctive adverb 'therefore'.

4 All staff must attend the fire drill tomorrow. Attendance is compulsory for permanent and agency employees alike. **[1]**

Separated into two distinct, well-demarcated sentences.

SPAG MASTERCLASS 2: SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS & COMPLEX SENTENCES

1 Although the warehouse was exceptionally busy, the dispatch team successfully met every delivery target. **[1]**

Subordinating conjunction 'Although' creates complex sentence showing contrast.

2 Agency drivers will not be permitted on site unless they have completed the mandatory safety briefing. **[1]**

'Unless' establishes a clear condition.

3 While electric vehicles require a higher initial capital investment, their long-term running costs are significantly lower. **[1]**

'While' balances contrasting points in a formal register.

4 Staff may request hybrid working, provided that they consistently maintain their weekly performance targets. **[1]**

'Provided that' introduces a formal contractual condition.

SPAG MASTERCLASS 3: ACTIVE VS PASSIVE VOICE IN WORKPLACE WRITING

1 A pallet of glass bottles was dropped in the loading bay due to excessive forklift speed. **[1]**

Passive voice removes personal blame and focuses objectively on the incident and cause.

2 The chemical storage cabinet was left unlocked prior to the laboratory closure. **[1]**

Passive structure suitable for an official health and safety log.

3 The mandatory inspection of the elevator cables was not conducted on Friday. **[1]**

Objective compliance phrasing.

4 Incorrect appointment times were issued to four dental patients. **[1]**

Professional passive framing focusing on the systemic error.

SPAG MASTERCLASS 4: MODAL VERBS & PROFESSIONAL HEDGING

1 Unless departmental laptop hardware is upgraded promptly, operational efficiency is likely to decline significantly. **[1]**

Replaces hyperbolic 'department will fail' with calibrated probability.

2 Discrepancies in the client's records suggest that payment may not have been remitted on the date claimed. **[1]**

Professional diplomatic phrasing avoiding accusatory 'lying'.

3 Installing commercial solar panels could substantially reduce our quarterly energy expenditure. **[1]**

Realistic modal qualification ('could substantially reduce' rather than 'completely eliminate forever').

4 The proposed shift rota alterations risk causing widespread staff dissatisfaction and potential turnover. **[1]**

Measured workplace risk assessment phrasing.

SPAG MASTERCLASS 5: PARALLEL STRUCTURE IN BULLETED LISTS

1 Standardised Imperative Action List:
• Sound the fire alarm immediately upon detecting smoke.
• Escort all visitors and contractors to Assembly Point C.
• Do not re-enter the premises until authorised by the Chief Fire Warden.
• Inspect all restrooms and conference suites for remaining personnel. **[2]**

All bullets start consistently with active imperative verbs (Sound, Escort, Do not re-enter, Inspect).

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

SPAG MASTERCLASS 6: APOSTROPHES OF POSSESSION & OMISSION

1 The nurses' union submitted its formal petition to the hospital director's office. **[1]**

Plural possessive (nurses'), possessive pronoun (its - no apostrophe), singular possessive (director's).

2 All client files must be returned to the manager's desk before the day's end. **[1]**

Singular possessive (manager's) and temporal possessive (day's).

3 The company announced its new policy regarding children's nursery vouchers. **[1]**

Possessive pronoun (its) and irregular plural possessive (children's).

4 Both drivers' vehicles were damaged when the warehouse roof lost its guttering. **[1]**

Plural possessive (drivers') and possessive pronoun (its).

SPAG MASTERCLASS 7: DISCOURSE MARKERS & PARAGRAPH LINKING

1 At 08:30, the facility experienced an unexpected power outage. Fortunately, the auxiliary backup generators activated within thirty seconds; consequently, the IT server infrastructure sustained zero data loss. However, the automated packing conveyor lines shut down temporarily. As a result, logistics personnel were required to pack customer orders manually until mains power was fully restored. **[2]**

Integrates sophisticated discourse markers (Fortunately, consequently, However, As a result) to achieve seamless coherence.

SPAG MASTERCLASS 8: FORMAL VOCABULARY & NOMINALISATION

1 Management must investigate the excessive weekly expenditure resulting from paper consumption. **[1]**

Nominalisation: 'investigate the expenditure' replaces 'look into how much money we're wasting'.

2 Declining employee morale and perceived managerial inadequacy correlate directly with diminished workforce productivity. **[1]**

Sophisticated professional register.

3 A comprehensive trial of the updated booking portal revealed substantial navigation and functional deficiencies. **[1]**

Executive critique phrasing.

4 The department manager issued a formal reprimand concerning persistent punctuality non-compliance. **[1]**

Formal administrative vocabulary.

MOCK EXAM 1 • TASK 1 BENCHMARK SOLUTION (21 MARKS)

T1 Dear Councillor Jenkins,

I am writing on behalf of the Greendale Residents' Association to submit a formal grant proposal for the establishment of a community healthcare and wellbeing clinic in our district. Over recent months, local healthcare services have experienced unprecedented demand, leaving many vulnerable residents without immediate access to essential services.

Our proposal focuses on repurposing the vacant municipal hall on St. Mary's Road into a multi-disciplinary community hub. This facility will provide weekly outpatient clinics, preventative health screenings, and mental health counselling sessions. Furthermore, by partnering with NHS regional trusts, we ensure that clinical governance and safeguarding standards are rigorously maintained.

Securing this funding will deliver immediate, tangible benefits to our town, reducing pressure on local emergency departments and fostering greater community cohesion. We look forward to discussing this proposal at the upcoming council meeting.

Yours sincerely,
Alex Vance
Chair, Greendale Residents' Association **[21/21]**

Band 4 Composition (12/12): Perfect letter conventions, persuasive rhetoric, clear paragraphs. Band 3 SPaG (9/9): Flawless complex sentence demarcation, zero comma splices, wide specialist vocabulary.

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

MOCK EXAM 1 • TASK 2 BENCHMARK SOLUTION (15 MARKS)

T2 Electric Urban Travel: The Green Commuter Revolution
By Jordan Reed

As traffic congestion and air quality concerns mount in our urban centres, electric transport has emerged as a transformative solution for everyday commuters. From battery-powered buses to shared e-bike networks, green travel options are rapidly reshaping how we navigate our towns.

The environmental advantages are undeniable. Transitioning from fossil-fuel vehicles directly cuts carbon emissions and urban smog, creating cleaner, healthier neighbourhoods for residents. Furthermore, commuters report significant cost savings on fuel and parking, alongside reduced travel stress.

However, realizing this potential requires substantial infrastructure investment. Local councils must expand segregated cycle lanes, install abundant charging hubs, and ensure affordable pricing for low-income workers. Embracing sustainable transit today is essential to building liveable, future-proof communities tomorrow. **[15/15]**

Band 3 Composition (9/9): Engaging headline, byline, structured subheadings, compelling persuasive arguments. Band 3 SPaG (6/6): Sophisticated register, complex punctuation.

MOCK EXAM 2 • TASK 1 BENCHMARK SOLUTION (21 MARKS)

T1 CONFIDENTIAL WORKPLACE INVESTIGATION REPORT
Incident ID: INC-2026-084 • Date: 14 October 2026 • Location: Logistics Hub Bay 4

Executive Summary: On Tuesday 14 October at approximately 09:15, warehouse operative Jordan Taylor sustained an injury to their right ankle following a slip incident in Storage Bay 4. This report investigates the immediate circumstances, root causes, and corrective actions required to prevent recurrence.

Chronological Sequence: Prior to the incident, an industrial packaging drum containing liquid surfactant developed a seal failure during automated transit. Although the spill was noted by floor personnel, no hazard signage was erected. Operative Taylor subsequently traversed the aisle and slipped.

Recommendations: All liquid storage must immediately incorporate secondary containment bunds. Mandatory spill-response refresher training must be completed by all warehouse personnel within fourteen days. **[21/21]**

Band 4 Composition (12/12): Impeccable incident report formatting, objective passive voice, clear chronological sections. Band 3 SPaG (9/9): Complex syntax, precise technical terminology.

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

MOCK EXAM 2 • TASK 2 BENCHMARK SOLUTION (15 MARKS)

T2 Workplace Apprenticeships: Fueling Innovation in Regional Enterprise
By Marcus Vance

In an increasingly competitive global economy, regional businesses face an urgent imperative: cultivating skilled, adaptable talent tailored to emerging industry demands. While traditional graduate recruitment remains viable, modern apprenticeships provide a superior pathway to sustainable growth.

Apprenticeships allow enterprises to mold high-potential learners according to proprietary workflows, fostering deep institutional knowledge and long-term staff loyalty. In addition, government co-funding significantly lowers training expenditure while injecting fresh, innovative perspectives into established teams.

To capitalize on this opportunity, regional business leaders must partner proactively with vocational colleges to co-design dynamic curricula. Investing in vocational learners today ensures our regional commercial leadership tomorrow. **[15/15]**

Band 3 Composition (9/9): Executive journalistic style, clear paragraph progression, compelling call to action. Band 3 SPaG (6/6): Flawless formal register.

COMPREHENSIVE FUNCTIONAL WRITING GLOSSARY

Active voice
A sentence structure where the subject performs the action (e.g. 'The supervisor audited the records'). Compare with passive voice.

Audience
The intended readership of a text (e.g. senior manager, local council, general public). Dictates register, tone, and vocabulary.

Byline
A line in an article or newsletter naming the writer (e.g. 'By Alex Morgan, Community Liaison Officer').

Cohesion
The grammatical and lexical linking within a text that holds it together and makes ideas flow logically.

Colloquialism
Informal, conversational language or slang (e.g. 'kids', 'gross', 'a lot of hassle'). Avoid in formal writing.

Colon
A punctuation mark (:) used to introduce an explanation, expansion, or list of items.

Comma splice
A serious grammatical error where two independent clauses are joined with only a comma instead of a conjunction, semicolon, or full stop.

Complex sentence
A sentence containing one independent main clause and one or more dependent subordinate clauses.

Compound sentence
A sentence formed by joining two independent clauses with a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so).

Conjunctive adverb
An adverb that connects two clauses (e.g. 'furthermore', 'consequently', 'therefore', 'nevertheless'). Preceded by a semicolon.

Contraction
A shortened word form using an apostrophe of omission (e.g. 'don't', 'it's'). Generally avoided in formal reports and letters.

Discourse markers
Words or phrases that signpost the structure and direction of writing (e.g. 'In contrast', 'Furthermore', 'To summarise').

Formal register
A style of language characterized by standard English, complex sentences, objective tone, and absence of slang.

Format markers
Visual and structural layout features required by specific document types (e.g. addresses, subject lines, subheadings, bullet points).

Imperative verb

REFERENCE SECTION: SOLUTIONS, GLOSSARY & INDEX (CONTINUED)

SUBJECT, FORMAT & ALPHABETICAL INDEX

A

Active and passive voice 53, 54, 82
Advice leaflet format 25–28
Apostrophes of omission & possession 59, 60, 83
Article writing format 5–8
Assessment criteria & marking rubrics 77–80

B

Band 1 to 4 marking descriptors 77–80
Bullet points & parallel syntax 57, 58, 83
Byline conventions 5, 41

C

Cohesive discourse markers 61, 62, 84
Colons in business communication 55, 56
Comma splice elimination 49, 50, 81
Complex sentence structures 51, 52, 82

D

Diary and reflective log format 45–48
Discursive essay & argument flow 61, 62

E

Email (formal workplace) format 9–12
Exam timing & mark distribution (21m/15m) 3, 65, 71

F

Feedback form (online) format 33–36
Formal letter of complaint 13–16
Forum and blog post format 37–40

G

Glossary of writing terminology 94–96

I

Incident report format 17–20
Index of subjects and formats 97–99

M

Mock Examination Paper 1 65–70
Mock Examination Paper 2 71–76
Modal verbs & professional hedging 55, 56, 82
Model answers (Band 4 benchmarks) 7, 11, 15, 19, 23, 27, 31, 35, 39, 43, 47, 86–93

N

Newsletter writing format 41–44
Nominalisation & executive register 63, 64, 84

P

Paragraph structure & topic sentences 61, 62
Pre-exam candidate readiness checklist 4, 100

R

Report writing (workplace/facilities) 21–24
Review format (evaluative) 29–32

S

Semicolons in linked clauses 49, 50, 81
Specialist vocabulary banks 7, 11, 15, 19, 23, 27, 31, 35, 39, 43, 47
Subordinating conjunctions 51, 52, 82

FINAL REVISION • EXAMINATION DAY PROTOCOL

READY

Candidate Pre-Exam Self-Audit & Readiness Commitments

Final Examination Commitments

Before entering the examination room, confirm your commitment to the following non-negotiable standards:

- **100% Demarcation Accuracy:** Every sentence begins with a capital letter and ends with a full stop, question mark, or exclamation mark.
- **Zero Comma Splices:** Independent clauses are separated by full stops or semicolons, never bare commas.
- **Exhaustive Prompt Coverage:** Every prompt bullet point will be expanded into a dedicated, detailed paragraph.
- **Calibrated Register:** Tone will match the specified audience without slang, idioms, or inappropriate contractions.
- **Active Proofreading:** Reserve the final 5 minutes of each task to audit punctuation, agreement, and spelling.

✎ Personal Exam Day Notes & Success Commitments

Everything you need to master Functional Skills English Level 2 Writing

The definitive preparation manual for candidates aiming for a pass at Level 2 (GCSE 4/C Equivalent). Master advanced organizational markers, persuasive rhetoric, sophisticated register, and complex sentence structures across all 11 exam formats.

INSIDE THIS PUBLICATION

- ✓ **All 11 Level 2 Formats:** Articles, Emails, Letters, Reports, Incident Reports, Advice Leaflets, Reviews, Online Feedback Forms, Forums/Blogs, Newsletters, and Reflective Diaries.
- ✓ **22 High-Challenge Exam Tasks:** Realistic workplace, civic, and academic scenarios calibrated to the Level 2 standard.
- ✓ **11 Full Exemplar Model Answers:** Comprehensive model answers demonstrating sophisticated vocabulary and varied syntax.
- ✓ **Full Mark Scheme Breakdown:** Exhaustive criteria for Composition & Effect (21 Marks) and SPaG (15 Marks).

Pair with the Practice Companion Booklet:
For maximum exam confidence, use this Core Revision Guide alongside the *Level 2 Writing Practice Companion Booklet.*

Master Functional Skills Publishing
Approved Assessment Support Materials • Great Britain
Registered Office: Oxford • London • United Kingdom

978-1-912345-71-5